

As a social reformer, he set his face against (sternly opposed) nautch parties.

At the battle of Marengo, Napoleon was within an ace of (on the point of) defeat (i.e., he was very nearly defeated).

2

The belief in witchcraft is losing ground (becoming less powerful or acceptable).

Lord Roberts first won his laurels (acquired distinction or glory) in India.

It was in parliamentary debate that he won his spurs (made his reputation as a politician).

When the prodigal returned to his father's house, he was received with open arms (with a warm welcome).

How can you trust a man who plays fast and loose (says one thing and does another) ?

I took him to task (rebuked him) for reading "penny dreadfuls".

He turned a deaf ear to (disregarded) my advice.

That argument will not hold water (stand scrutiny i.e., it is unsound).

He is determined to achieve his object by hook or by crook (by fair means or foul; by any means he can).

To all intents and purposes (practically, virtually) the Prime Minister of Nepal was the ruler of the country.

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3

The singer, having a slight cough, was not in voice (unable to sing well) at the concert.

These two statements do not hang together (i.e., are not consistent with each other).

This is more than flesh and blood (human nature) can endure.

He accepted my statement without reserve (fully, implicitly).

I must take exception to (object to) your remark.

He is indulgent to a fault (i.e., he is over-indulgent; so indulgent that his indulgence is a fault).

The belief in efficacy of vaccination is gaining ground (becoming more general).

From his attitude it is clear that he wants to pay off old scores (to have his revenge).

He has been working on and off (at intervals) several years to compile a dictionary.

He visits me off and on (now and then, occasionally).

4

At least on the question of child-marriage we are at one (of the same opinion).
He took my advice in good part (without offence ; i.e., he did not resent it).
It was he who put a spoke in my wheel (thwarted me in the execution of my design).
At an early age he made his mark (distinguished himself) as a chemist.
I have it at my fingers' ends (know it thoroughly).
The new play has fallen flat (met with a cold reception).
Where discipline is concerned I put my foot down (take a resolute stand).
It is a matter of gratification to me that he has turned over a new leaf (changed for the better; begun a different mode of life).
I have made up my mind (resolved, decided) to retire from business.
This puts me in mind (reminds me) of an amusing incident.

5

There's no love lost between them (i.e., they are not on good terms, they dislike each other).
Many people in that country live from hand to mouth (i.e., without any provision for the future).
Steady work is sure to be rewarded in the long run (eventually, ultimately).
Whatever else one may say of him, no one dare call in question (challenge, express a doubt about) his honesty of purpose.
The police came to the scene in the nick of time (just at the right moment, opportunely).
She stood by him through thick and thin (under all conditions, undaunted by anything).
His partner threw cold water on his scheme (discouraged him by showing indifference to it).
He can turn his hand to (adapt or apply himself to) anything.
The Sultan rules his subjects with a high hand (oppressively).
He is hand and glove (on very intimate terms) with my cousin.

6

He turns even his errors to account (i.e., profits by them).
He is accused of sitting on the fence (halting between two opinions, heistating which said to join).